

MANDAR DEODHAR

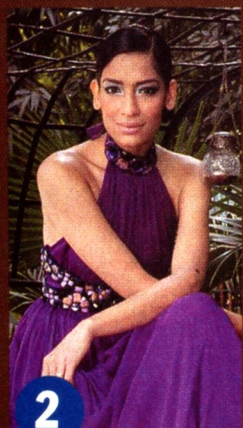
THE LOOK BOOK

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1 METAL TIME All that glitters is good. Fall looks at silver, bronze and gold finishes with a new eye.

2 COLOUR PURPLE Violet, lavender, wine, aubergine and other hues of the colour purple get set to make a royal splash along with chocolate chic.

3 LUXURY LINE Sumptuous silks meet lush velvets, jacquards, cashmere and jersey drapes to make up a luxe look.



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collection Black Earth is "an ode to the erosion of colour and light that was our inheritance and the transition to the barren grey and brown of our earth today" and she tells her story through a "dark and intensive" palette of charcoal, chocolate, brunt bronze and asphalt grey.

But light autumnal musings are also not far behind. While Ranna Gill's Autumn Garden showcases an interplay of tulips, gardenia and geo-floral prints on floor-length gowns and flirty dresses, Soni's finesse will be showcased at the finale where the accent is "on luxury, indulgence and intimacy. A feeling of richness prevails throughout with a nod to romance intellect warmth and an esoteric type of beauty". Mumbai designer Monisha Jaising also focuses on luxurious romanticism with "vibrant colours and prints inspired by India".

The doyens of drama will add their unique spin to the couture cornucopia. Freshly picked from PFW, Manish Arora's collection will be a study in collaboration. Stamped with his inimitable sense of humour, his samurais

GAYATRI KHANNA Jewels of the Forest in the Creator section is inspired by the need to save our greens.

"Solid and rich colours like purple, plum, grey and charcoal will be this fall's winning shades."

and warriors will meet baroque motifs, artist Keiichi Tanaami's artwork, Swarovski elements and Disney cartoons. Rohit Bal, on the other hand, will dazzle with a line of metallics in Ashta Dhatu, inspired by an ancient artistic tradition that involves the combining of eight different metals for creating a variety of aesthetic objects. Copper hues, deep chocolate and the glitz of gold and silver come alive in his fall line.

Even as over 60 labels are poised to take a bow in nearly 40 shows over five hedonistically feverish days with great potential on display, no one knows the fickleness of fashion as well as trend-spotters who have been left clutching their cue sheets at the end of a promising mode mirage. Fashion watchers, designer-thread toggling socialites and even international style scouts will have their eyes firmly fixed on the runways in Delhi. Here's hoping the fruits of this fall will rise to the occasion. ■

4 STRUCTURE THIS Clean cuts and structured silhouettes spell class in fall's fuss-free lines.

Creations (top to bottom) by Mandira Wirk, Renu Tandon, Priya Awasthy (right) and Ekru

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